

W.S.
Gong

Developer.
Writer, Editor.

San Francisco, CA
www.ws-gong.com/code | linkedin.com/in/billy-gong
billygong@me.com

Full-stack engineer with twenty-five years in software, building production AI systems end to end. Runs the operational software for a working San Francisco bookstore: shift and event scheduling and in-house book-search, live on Next.js, Postgres, and the Anthropic stack, with a multi-agent operations platform in active build. Ships MCP servers, Claude Code plugins, and CLIs in the open at www.ws-gong.com/code. At Slack, held quality authority across eight feature teams and built developer tooling adopted across the platform.

Skills

- Platforms
- Vercel, Neon Postgres, Docker, Git
- Languages
- Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, Node.js, Ruby, React/Next.js
- AI & Agents
- Anthropic SDK (Claude), MCP servers, Claude Code plugins, tool-use loops, multi-agent orchestration, prompt engineering

- Documentation
- API references, developer guides, SDK tutorials, quickstarts, docs-as-code (Markdown, Vale, Git), OpenAPI/Swagger, JSON Schema
- Testing & CI
- Playwright, Cypress, Pytest/Jest, JMeter, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Circle CI)

Experience

2022–PRESENT
SAN FRANCISCO, CA

- Open-Source AI Developer Tooling
- Independent
- Colophon: book-search engine in daily use at Fabulosa Books, shipped as both an MCP server for Claude Code and an Express app. TypeScript, MCP SDK, Docker. Lit Verity: MCP server grounding claims against an indexed corpus to block hallucinated citations. TypeScript, Neon, pgvector. Two Claude Code research plugins on the Anthropic SDK: retrieval, citation cross-checking, confidence scoring.

2022–PRESENT
SAN FRANCISCO, CA

- Technical Lead & Bookseller
- Fabulosa Books
- Built a scheduling system that automates staff shifts and event promotion: creating an event once publishes the Eventbrite listing, email blast, and Instagram and Facebook posts in a single step, freeing staff to focus on customers. Next.js, Postgres. Colophon serves as the in-house book lookup. Architected a multi-agent operations platform (an orchestrator over availability, fairness, coverage, and communication agents on the Anthropic stack), documented as a public 7-part developer tutorial.

2024–2026
REMOTE

- Fiction Editor
- The Rumpus
- Ran the full editorial pipeline, intake to production, under Editor-in-Chief Roxane Gay: hundreds of submissions per cycle; mentored junior editors.

2023–2025
SAN FRANCISCO, CA

Adjunct Faculty

San Francisco State University

Taught Introduction to Creative Writing across four semesters (20–45 students per class), with consistently strong evaluations. Faculty advisor for Transfer Magazine, the university's undergraduate literary journal: directed its 12-member editorial team through biannual print production.

2017–2020
SAN FRANCISCO, CA

Technical Lead Manager / Staff Engineer

Slack Technologies

Wrote the API references, SDK guides, and platform tutorials used across its platform; built internal Web API tooling that external developers adopted as official documentation examples. First QA engineer on the Slack Platform: owned QA end to end for eight feature teams (Block Kit, Workflows, platform APIs) in the Platform QA organization, tested the public API, directed four staff/senior engineers, promoted three.

2017
REMOTE

Security Product QA (Contract)

Confidential (under NDA)

Abuse-case testing for a security product: designed scenarios validating that it flagged known exploits from public catalogs (CISA, Exploit-DB).

2015–2017
SAN FRANCISCO, CA

Senior SDET

Appthority (acquired by Symantec)

First QA hire; defined the testing approach and infrastructure for an MDM-based mobile security product that profiled apps by their behavior: installed on a device, captured pcap-level traffic, generated risk reports. Learned R to audit those reports for the false positives and inconsistencies that meant the collection pipeline, not the app, was at fault. Built the E2E automation (Cucumber, Rails, Selenium, Circle CI) and authored API specs and architecture records that transferred intact through the acquisition.

2012–2015
SAN MATEO, CA

Senior Quality Assurance Engineer

GoPro

First SDET on a team of manual testers. Built a Ruby REST API testing framework with OAuth and a custom gem for automated RSpec generation; adversarial testing of the platform's file-upload service. Established the org-wide JMeter performance practice; cut load-testing time 70%.

1997–2012

Earlier Experience

Quality Engineering Manager, Kyte (2010–2012); Senior QA Engineer, Coincident TV (2008–2010); Flex Builder Software QE III, Adobe Systems (2006–2008); Senior QA Engineer, Keepmedia (2003–2006); Senior Sales Engineer, FutureTrade Technologies (2001–2003); SQA Engineering Lead, Pixel Translations (1997–2001).

Education

2021–2024

MFA, Creative Writing (Fiction), with distinction

San Francisco State University

Faculty Lecturer; coursework in technical editing and writing.

1995

BA, Philosophy and English

University of California, Santa Barbara

2023

Certificate in Professional Editing

UC Berkeley Extension

Publications & Activity

Short fiction published in Fourteen Hills; alumni of Bread Loaf, Sewanee, Tin House, Kenyon, VONA, VCCA.

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July 3, 2026

Dear Developer Success hiring team,

I am a full-stack engineer with twenty-five years in software, and for the past three years I have run a production application on Next.js and Vercel: the operational software for Fabulosa Books in San Francisco, covering staff scheduling, automated event promotion, and an in-house book-search engine backed by Postgres and the Anthropic stack. I am interested in the Developer Success Engineer role at Vercel because it maps directly to my current work: engaging with customers, understanding what they need, and building and shipping the solution.

Your listing calls for someone who can guide customers through onboarding and go-live, troubleshoot issues across Next.js, serverless functions, and build pipelines, and translate those engagements into documentation and playbooks. That is what I do on Vercel: I ship to the platform, diagnose what breaks, and document the fix so it does not recur. At Slack I wrote the API references, SDK guides, and platform tutorials that external developers built against, and I built internal Web API tooling adopted by those developers as official examples. As Technical Lead Manager for Platform QA, I owned quality across eight feature teams, including Block Kit and Workflows, partnering with product, engineering, and developer relations to unblock releases. My open-source work runs on the same stack as Vercel: MCP servers and Claude Code plugins, shipped in the open at ws-gong.com/code.

I have spent twenty-five years on one kind of problem: finding where a system fails, resolving it, and writing the account that keeps the next engineer from repeating it. I want to do that with Vercel's customers, turning each fix into documentation for the next customer to build on.

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